

Sangwon Ju

Department of Public Administration & Policy, School of Public Affairs, American University
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Education

American University	Washington D.C., United States
Ph.D. Candidate in Public Administration & Policy	2024-2028 May (Expected)
Committee: Dr. John D. Marvel (Chair), Dr. Kenneth J. Meier, Dr. Sheeling Neo	
Seoul National University	Seoul, Republic of Korea
Master of Public Policy	2021-2023
Thesis: The Role of Information Technology on Improving Organizational Performance [in Korean]	
Advisor: Dr. Byeong Jo Kim	
Yonsei University	Seoul, Republic of Korea
B.A. in Public Administration & B.B.A. in Business Administration	2015-2021
Minor in Applied Statistics	

Research Interests

Public Management, Behavioral Public Administration, Human-AI interaction, Policy Implementation, Organizational Theory/Behavior, Comparative Public Administration, Computational Social Science

Peer-Reviewed Publications

In English

- Marvel, John D., Sheeling Neo, Rachel Cho, and **Sangwon Ju**. Forthcoming. "Large Language Models and Conversational Counter-Argument to Anti-Public Sector Bias." *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*.
- Lee, Jaeho, **Sangwon Ju**, and Byeong Jo Kim. 2026. "Policy Compliance Under Disagreement: The Joint Roles of Duty/Deterrence Beliefs, Symbolic Ideology, and Policy Environment." *Review of Policy Research* 43 (2): e70084.

In Korean

- Jeon, Yeejin, and **Sangwon Ju**. 2024. "A Study on the Cost Behavior of LPEs: Focusing on the Geographical Features of Auditors." *Public Audit and Inspection Review* 43: 59–78.
- Lee, Jaeho, and **Sangwon Ju**. 2024. "Effects of Local Government Leaders' Characteristics on Institutionalized Citizen Participation: Evidence from Participatory Budgeting." *The Korean Journal of Local Government Studies* 28 (2): 55–86.
- Ju, Sangwon**, Jaeho Lee, and Byeong Jo Kim. 2022. "Evidence-Based Policy in Asian Countries: A Comparative Analysis of Evidence-Based Policy Implementation in Myanmar, Indonesia, Hong Kong, Japan, and South Korea." *Korean Society and Public Administration* 33 (3): 97–131.

Manuscripts Under Review

- Marvel, John D., and **Sangwon Ju**. "Inoculating citizens against anti-government sycophancy in large language models"
 - Under review at *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory* (Preprint at [SSRN](#))
 - Presented at PMRC 2026; APSA 2026
- **Ju, Sangwon**, and John D. Marvel "Size is interesting: Span of control and frontline performance management"
 - Under review at *Public Administration Review*
 - Presented at PMRC 2025; DC Consortium 2025
- **Ju, Sangwon**, and Kenneth J. Meier. "Structural publicness in the eyes of citizens: Experimental evidence on tradeoffs in the U.S. and South Korea."
 - Under review at *Public Administration*
 - Presented at MPSA 2026

Work in Progress

Manuscript Available

- Neo, Sheeling, and **Sangwon Ju**. "What is public employee identity? A cross-national examination."
 - Presented at PMRC 2025; EGPA 2025
- **Ju, Sangwon**, and Kenneth J. Meier. "The long-run consequence of female teacher representation: A natural experiment in Korea"
- Kenneth J. Meier, Grant Mobley, and **Ju, Sangwon**. "Maximizing efficiency with a within-subjects' forced-choice design" (Preprint at [SSRN](#))
- **Ju, Sangwon**, and John D. Marvel. "Debiasing the Undebiasable? Motivated Reasoning, Political Sophistication, and LLMs in Citizen Performance Evaluation"
- **Ju, Sangwon**. "Congressional Oversight, Transparency, and Federal FOIA Administration"

Data Analysis / Experimental Design Stage

- Kenneth J. Meier, and **Sangwon Ju** "Comparative Analysis on Organizational Structure and Autonomy"
- John D. Marvel, and **Sangwon Ju** "Ideological Asymmetries in Selection into LLM Sycophancy"
- **Ju, Sangwon**, and Sheeling Neo "LLM Sycophancy and Moral Disempowerment among Street-Level Bureaucrats" [Dissertation Essay 1]

Conference Presentations (* planned; † presented by co-author)

In English

† Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Annual Conference, Boston, MA	2026
* American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA), Boston, MA	2026
Public Management Research Conference (PMRC), Washington, DC	2026
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference (MPSA), Chicago, IL	2026
Public Management Research Conference (PMRC), Seoul, South Korea	2025
Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference (MPSA), Chicago, IL	2025

DC Public Management Consortium (Georgetown University), Washington, DC	2025
[†] American Society for Public Administration Annual Conference (ASPA), Minneapolis, MN	2024
SNU-VUW BK21 Conference, Auckland Central, Auckland, New Zealand	2024

In Korean

[†] Korea Productivity Association Spring Conference, Seoul, Korea	2024
• <i>Best Paper Award (\$500), Korea Productivity Association & Institute Audit and Inspection Research</i>	

Research Experience

Department of Public Administration & Policy, AU	Washington D.C., United States
• Graduate Assistant (Advisor: Dr. John D. Marvel; Dr. Sheeling Neo)	2024-2028
• Research Assistant (Advisor: Dr. Kenneth J. Meier)	2025-2028

Evidence-Based Lab for Public Policy and Management, SNU	Seoul, Republic of Korea
• Research Assistant (Advisor: Dr. Byeong Jo Kim)	2021-2024
• Participated in biannual research-oriented seminars on selected topics	
◦ Contemporary Research in OB and PA II	Jul 2024
◦ Contemporary Theories in OB and PA	Feb 2024
◦ Contemporary Research in OB and PA I	Aug 2023
◦ Research Methods: HLM, PLM, Meta-analysis and SR, LPA/LCA, SEM	Feb 2023
◦ Organizational Behavior & Organizational Psychology	Aug 2022
◦ Evidence-based Management and Measurement Issues	Jan-Feb 2022
◦ Evidence-based Policy: Current Issues	Oct-Nov 2021

Korea Research Institute for Local Administration	Wonju, Republic of Korea
• Research Assistant, Office of Local Administration and Innovation	2022
◦ Conducted Data collection and analysis for the “Studies on the Analysis and Diagnosis of Local Government Organizations (2022)”	

Teaching Experience

American University	
• Intro to Public Administration and the Policy Process (PUAD-612)	Spring, Fall 2025; Spring 2026
◦ Teaching Assistant (Instructor: Dr. Sheeling Neo)	
◦ Supervised and graded student research proposals	
Seoul National University	
• Evidence-based Public Policy and Management (Global MPA; M2856.001900)	Spring 2023
◦ Teaching Assistant (English-Taught; Instructor: Dr. Kim, ByeongJo)	
◦ Supervised the development of research proposals for Global MPA students	
• Research Methods for Public Policy Case Study (Global MPA; 920.703)	Winter 2023
◦ Teaching Assistant (English-Taught; Instructor: Dr. Kum, Hyunsub & Kim, ByeongJo)	
◦ Stata programming sessions, developed and graded assignments for MPA students	

Scholarship & Award

Fellow

- Summer Academy Fellow, School of Public Affairs, American University 2025

Scholarship

- Graduate Assistantship and Tuition Scholarship, American University 2024-2028
- Brain Korea 21 Scholarship, National Research Foundation of Korea (\$7,500) 2023-2024
- Graduate Student Instructor Scholarships, Seoul National University (\$5,000) 2021, 2023
- Merit-based Scholarship (High Honor: top 3 percent), Yonsei University (\$ 3,000) 2021

Award

- Yonsei Certificate For Excellence: Understanding and Using AI 2021
 - Project: Disaster Management and AI: CNN Algorithms on Satellite Images

Governmental and Public Sector Projects

1. "Establishment and Plans for a Sustainable Development Research Center (2024)", Research Assistant, *The Korean Association for Policy Studies*, prepared for the *Office for Government Policy Coordination of Korea*
2. "Quantitative Housing Demand Estimation in Cheonan-Jiksan District (2024)", Research Assistant, *The International Convergence Management Association*, prepared for the *Korea Land and Housing Corporation*
3. "Developing Framework for Efficient Management of Public Assets: Cost-Benefit Analysis (2024)", Research Assistant, *Korean Urban Management Association*, prepared for the *Seoul Metropolitan City*

Work Experience

- Korean Augmentation to the United States Army** Seoul, Republic of Korea
Administrative Assistant / Translator (Sergeant) 2016-2017
- Mandatory Military Service in United States Forces Korea Transformation & Restationing
 - Served in the Director's Office (Major General) and was discharged upon completing military duty

Professional Service and Affiliations

Ad hoc Journal Referee Service

- Review of Public Personnel Administration (x1)

Professional Membership

- Public Management Research Association
- American Political Science Association
- Midwest Political Science Association

Proficiencies

Methodology

Panel Data Analysis, Multilevel Modelling, Structural Equation Modelling, Choice Data Modeling (Conjoint & Discrete Choice), GIS, Machine Learning, Text Analysis, Web-Scraping, Visualization

Software

R (w/ tidyverse; proficient), Stata (proficient), Python (proficient), Tableau, PostgreSQL, QGIS, LaTeX

Languages

Korean (native), English (fluent)